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Tramways



Railways

Indian Railway is the largest Railway Organization in the world. The Indian Nationwide network, the 4th longest in the world, is owned and operated by State-Owned Indian Railways and includes an operating route length of more than 65,000 Kms. The network carried about 8 billion passengers (the highest in the world) in 2013.

of tracks, construction of bridges, purchase of locomotives etc. Railways are among the biggest public utilities of a country. Rail transport is a means of transferring of passengers and goods on wheeled vehicles running on rails (tracks). Rail transport stated to be important in the Industrial Revolution.

There are three types of tracks that are in operation. They are (I) Meter gauge (ii) Broad gauge and (iii) Narrow gauge

Advantages of Railway Transport

1. Railways are well suited for carrying heavy and bulky goods over long distances.
2. It can provide long distance travel throughout the day and night with unbroken services.
3. It can provide better production and safety to the goods than motor transport. The goods generally carried in closed wagons are not exposed to sun, rain etc.
4. Though initial investment is large, in the long run the operating expenses will be very low in railways and it will prove a cheaper mode of transport.

   It requires less time than motor transport for carrying goods over long distance with greater speed
5. It has regular schedule of timing and is available throughout the year.
6. It provides unaffected services whether rainy or shinny weather conditions.

Disadvantages of Railway Transport

1. Railway rates are relatively higher than motor transport for transporting light weight articles over short distance.
2. It is inflexible, as it is operated to a particular track which cannot deviate from the set routes.
3. In rural areas, it cannot offer adequate traffic because of uneconomical operating cost.